RYAN BIGG

CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE TEAM LEAD



ABOUT ME

Customer Experience team lead and L2 support engineer for a payments platform. Direct manager of a growing team, owner of the on-call rotation, and a regular voice for customers in product planning. Comfortable discussing APIs and integrations with customers, partner banks and engineers alike.

CONTACT

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SKILLS

- Support Leadership
- L2 Support / Escalations
- On-call Management
- Zendesk
- SLAs
- APIs & Integrations
- Mentoring
- Voice of the Customer
- Documentation

I led the Customer Experience team at a payment processing company, managing developers who answered customer-facing tickets for the merchant API and Merchant Dashboard. I was the direct manager of 8 people (1:1s, performance reviews, hiring), set up its on-call process, escalation paths and incident runbooks, and worked as an L2 support engineer myself, joining phone and video calls when tickets needed it.

I take customer feedback into planning and let it shape what gets built. I use AI tools like Claude Code deliberately, keeping human review and existing team guardrails in place. I have a long history of writing documentation and technical books.

EXPERIENCE

Customer Experience Team Lead — Fat Zebra 2021 – Aug 2026

Grew the Customer Experience team from 2 to 12, with 8 direct reports. Alongside leading the team, worked as an L2 support engineer for the API and Merchant Dashboard. Led work with NAB and BNZ to theme the Merchant Dashboard and build new features for the banks' merchants.

- Support: handled customer-facing tickets in Zendesk, escalating through the support stack to phone and Zoom/Teams calls when needed, against strict uptime and SLA requirements (tickets turned around in under two weeks).
- Process: rolled out the team's on-call process, escalation paths and incident runbooks, and introduced retrospectives.
- Management: ran 1:1s, performance reviews and hiring; mentored multiple developers to mid and senior level and promoted three in 2024. Reshaped the team's hiring process in 2026.
- Documentation: wrote the API documentation and updated it based on customer feedback.
- Voice of the customer: brought customer feedback into planning sessions to drive decisions, including rebuilding the Merchant Dashboard from user feedback and building a React-based Design System from scratch.
- Integrations: part of the team that completed the port of the acquired SecurePay API, and led tech integration of the acquired payment gateway, now processing over $4 billion in payments.
- Also shipped Click to Pay (Mastercard, Visa, Amex), Apple Pay, multi-layered BIN blocking for fraud prevention, and adopted GraphQL across the Merchant Dashboard. Rolled out Claude Code across authoring and review.

Freelance Contractor — Various Feb – Aug 2021

Part-time "mercenary for hire" across TypeScript/React/Ruby stacks: one team upgrading jQuery componentry to TypeScript-powered React and adding platform stability measures (Ruby tests, CI, AppSignal monitoring), another upgrading a Rails 5.0 application to 6.1 and clearing deprecation warnings.

Full-time Developer — Various 2007 – 2021

Ruby on Rails development at Covidence, Culture Amp and LIFX.